October 2025, heavy rainfall caused flooding in several departments, damaging crops and livestock. At the end of October, Hurricane Melissa affected agricultural livelihoods and infrastructures in Sud, Sud-Est, Nippes, Grand'Anse and Artibonite departments, where operations of land preparation of the 2025 third (minor) season crops have been delayed. Elsewhere, abundant rains improved soil moisture levels and benefitted crop conditions. Planting operations of the third (minor) season maize and paddy crops are expected to conclude in December and the area sown is expected to be below the average level. Overall, aggregate cereal production in 2025, including the harvest of the main season crops that were affected by dry weather conditions, is expected at a below-average level.

Cereal import requirements for 2025/26 marketing year forecast at above-average level

Imports usually cover over 70 percent of total cereal consumption needs. In the 2025/26 marketing year (July/June), cereal import requirements, mostly wheat and rice, are forecast at about 1 million tonnes, stable year-on-year and around 10 percent above the five-year average.

High food inflation erodes purchasing power and limits access to food

Inflation has been in double digits since 2016 and, as of 2025, food prices remain high, with the annual food inflation rate at 35.1 percent in September 2025. Persistently high food prices continue to erode households' purchasing power and limit their access to food.

Retail prices of domestically produced black beans and maize meal were mostly stable in August and September 2025 in Port-au-Prince, reflecting improved seasonal supply from the main season harvest. Similarly, markets in other regions such as Artibonite, Centre, Grand Sud and Grand Nord are reported to be supplied with local harvests. Regarding imported food items, higher year-on-year imports in 2025 kept prices of wheat flour stable between July and September 2025. Similarly, prices of imported rice were mostly steady due to stable or weakening international quotations. Overall, prices of most food items remain largely above their five-year average.



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This brief was prepared using the following data/tools:
FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet (CCBS)
https://www.fao.org/giews/data-tools/en/.
FAO/GIEWS Food Price Monitoring and Analysis (FPMA) Tool
https://fpma.fao.org/.
FAO/GIEWS Earth Observation for Crop Monitoring
https://www.fao.org/giews/earthobservation/.
Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC) https://www.ipcinfo.org/.

hampering humanitarian operations. Food assistance is currently reaching less than 10 percent of the population whose basic needs are not expected to be met in the remaining months of 2024.

Below-average output for maize and paddy crops in 2024 spring season

Harvesting of the main season maize crop finalized in July 2024, while harvesting operations for the spring season paddy crop just ended in September. The outcome of both crops is estimated at a below-average level in the key producing Artibonite, Ouest and Centre departments, reflecting the reduction of planted area due to land abandonment, high labour costs and the difficult access to seeds and financing, amid worsening insecurity conditions. In addition, dry spells during the March-to-May 2024 period had a negative impact on crop establishment. Generally improved precipitation amounts from June to August provided conducive conditions for crop development.

Planting of the second season maize crop is ongoing and the harvest is expected to start in November. Dry weather conditions reported in September in the key producing areas are expected to have a negative impact on planting operations. The weather forecast points to above-average rainfall amounts in the October-to-December period, which may damage crops during the maturation and harvesting stages. The high likelihood of a severe hurricane season, associated with the La Niña phenomenon, raises the risk of significant crop losses and damage to infrastructures.

Cereal imports forecast above average in 2024/25

Cereal imports for the 2024/25 marketing year (July/June), mostly wheat and rice for food consumption, are anticipated at an above-average level of 735 000 tonnes. Despite the closure of the main seaport, cereal imports between June and August 2024 were above their year-earlier level, reflecting lower year-on-year international prices of wheat and rice.

Black beans and maize prices marginally declined due to improved seasonal availability

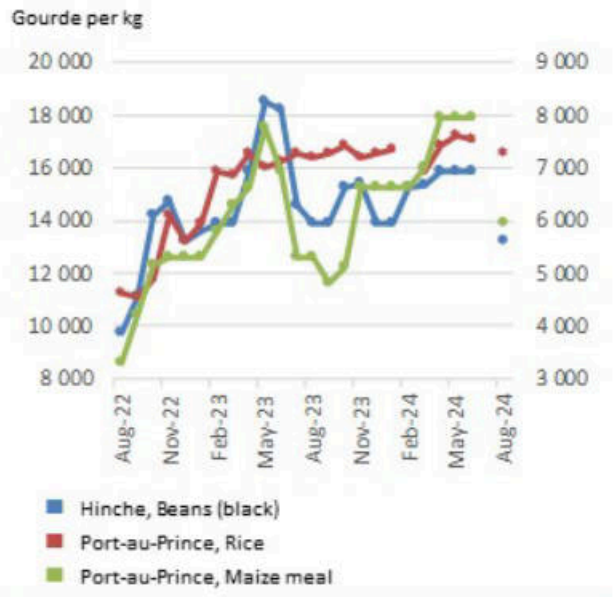
After four months of growth, prices of maize and black beans were stable during the April to July 2024 period and then decreased in August, reflecting improved seasonal availability on local markets. Prices of black beans in August were slightly lower than one year earlier, while prices of maize were about 12 percent higher year-on-year in Port-au-Prince market as a consequence of the low production obtained in 2023. Prices of imported rice, wheat and vegetable oil remained nearly unchanged between April and August, reflecting the stability of the gourde against the United States dollar.

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FAO/GIEWS Earth Observation for Crop Monitoring
https://www.fao.org/giews/earthobservation/.
Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC) https://www.ipcinfo.org/.

Haiti

Selected retail prices



Planted area to 2023 main maize and paddy crops expected at below-average level

Planting of the 2023 main season maize and paddy crops is nearing completion with some delay due to the late onset of seasonal rains. Some regions (Great South) experienced episodes of drought when the rainy season had started and crop growth had begun. In other areas, precipitation amounts improved in April, high temperatures and below-average rainfall amounts resulted in poor vegetation conditions across the country (VHI map). Planted area of maize and paddy crops is expected to remain at below-average levels, due to the adverse weather conditions at planting, but also by the low availability of seeds and the high costs of agricultural inputs and fuel.

Weather forecasts indicate average to above-average rainfall amounts and high temperatures in the June-August period. Although abundant rains are generally favourable for crop development, the combination with the elevated temperatures may cause pest infestations and thus, a close monitoring is required. The 2023 Atlantic hurricane season, which lasts from June to November, is forecast to be more active than average. If a hurricane makes a landfall, torrential rains and strong winds could damage standing crops, affecting livelihoods of farmers and reducing the availability of food.

Cereal imports anticipated at low levels in 2022/23

The cereal imports for the 2022/23 marketing year (July/June), mostly wheat and rice for food consumption, are anticipated at low levels due to the country's low financial capacity to face high international commodity prices with the weakening of the gourde. Higher year-on-year export prices of rice in the United States of America, the country's main supplier, have curbed domestic demand.

Prices of staple food items higher year-on-year in March 2023

Prices of local maize meal and black beans generally rose during the first three months of 2023, reflecting seasonally low availabilities. Prices of the two staple crops were well above their year-earlier levels in March, due to tight supplies from the below-average 2022 production, high transport costs and difficult access to markets. Prices of rice have been mostly on the rise throughout 2022 and first months of 2023, following upward trends in prices of imported rice. The sustained weakening of the gourde provided additional upward pressure on prices of imported food items, such as rice, wheat flour and vegetable oil. In general, food prices were at high levels, with the annual food inflation rate estimated at 48 percent in February 2023.

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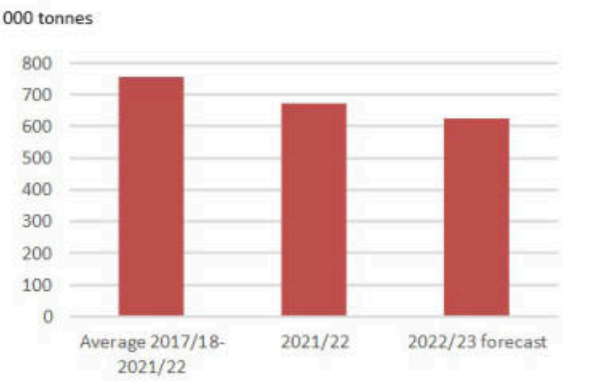
Cereal Production

	2018-2022 average	2022	2023 forecast	change 2023/2022
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	201	185	180	-2.7
Rice (paddy)	164	140	136	-2.9
Sorghum	15	15	15	0.0
Total	380	340	331	-2.6

Note: Percentage change calculated from unrounded data.

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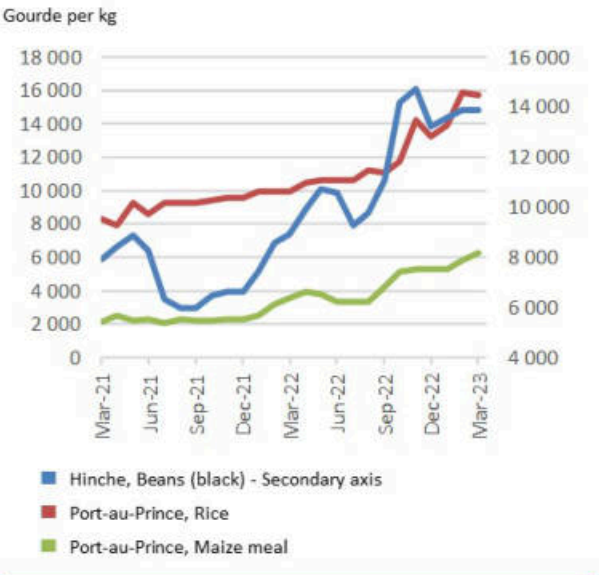
Cereals Imports



Note: Includes rice in milled terms. Split years refers to individual crop marketing years (for rice, calendar year of second year shown).

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Selected retail prices



Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
Haiti

Reference Date: 12-August-2022

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Surging violence, political stalemate and protracted economic crisis continue to affect food security**
- **Output of 2022 main maize and paddy crops expected at below-average level**
- **Cereal import requirements forecast near-average levels in 2022/23**
- **Prices of staple food well above year-earlier levels in June**

Surging violence, political stalemate and protracted economic crisis continue to affect food security

A sharp deterioration of the security situation since June 2021 has severely affected livelihoods and provision of humanitarian assistance, with a detrimental impact on food security outcomes. Violent clashes between armed gangs hampered households' access to markets and health, and education services in the capital. In the South, the blockage of road connecting southern areas with Port-au-Prince, which has lasted for more than a year, has reduced the supply of food and fuel as well as constrained access to basic services. Amid the political deadlock, the security situation is likely to deteriorate, further limiting access to food and affecting livelihoods. In addition, reduced access to humanitarian assistance, due to a shortfall in humanitarian funding and increasing costs of delivery of assistance, poses further threats.

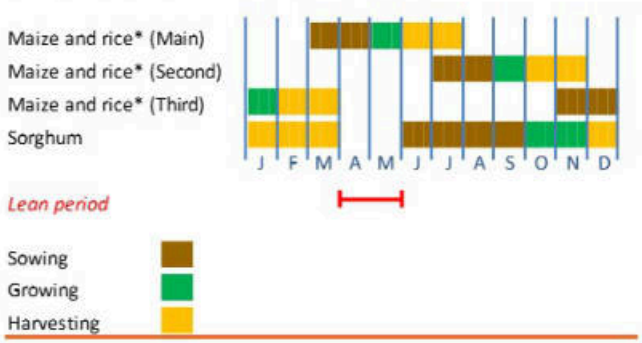
According to the latest IPC analysis, the number of people facing acute food insecurity (IPC Phase 3 [Crisis] or above) was estimated at a record of 4.5 million (45 percent of the population) in the March-June 2022 period, up from the 4.4 million in the same period in 2021. Food insecurity has been worsening since 2018, reflecting the sustained economic downturn and below-average agricultural production, compounded by surging gang violence and political instability.

Output of 2022 main maize and paddy crops expected at below-average level

Harvesting of the 2022 main season maize and rice crops was completed in July and production is expected at a below-average level. Following a timely onset of seasonal rains in April, precipitation amounts reduced to a below-average level in the May-June period and affected crop yields. In the key cereal producing department of Artibonite, accumulated rainfall between

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Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS, FEWSNET.

Sources: FAO/GIEWS, FEWSNET should be FEWS NET.

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Cereal Production

	2017-2021 average	2021	2022 forecast	change 2022/2021
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	218	200	185	-7.5
Rice (paddy)	171	155	140	-10.0
Sorghum	17	18	15	-16.7
Total	407	373	340	-9.0

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
Haiti

Reference Date: 12-November-2021

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Output of 2021 second season maize and paddy crops expected at below-average level**
- **Cereal import requirements forecast to increase in 2021/22**
- **Prices of rice stable between June and September 2021**
- **Low food availability and access affect about 4.3 million people**

Output of 2021 second season maize and paddy crops expected at below-average level

Harvesting of the 2021 minor second season maize and paddy crops is ongoing and production is expected at a below-average level. This is mainly due to overall below-average rainfall amounts between August and September, which hampered normal crop development (VHI map). Unfavourable production prospects were exacerbated by a series of adverse weather events (GIEWS Update). In mid-August, a 7.2-magnitude earthquake struck the southern region and caused extensive damages to agricultural and market infrastructures. Two days after, a tropical depression brought heavy rains and strong winds in Sud and Sud-Est departments, triggering flooding and landslides.

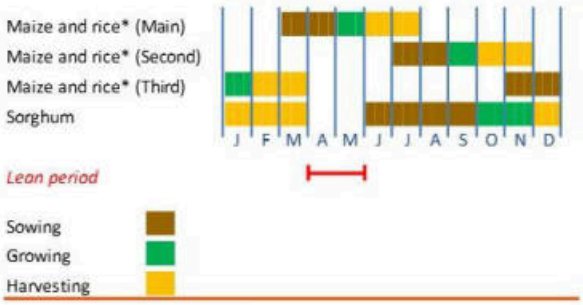
Land preparation of the 2021 minor third season has recently started in November. The current soil moisture deficits are likely to be reduced by average precipitation amounts, forecast for the November 2021 to January 2022 period. However, the planted area is anticipated to remain at a below-average level, mainly reflecting costly and scarce agricultural inputs, including seeds and fuel.

Cereal import requirements forecast to increase in 2021/22

The cereal import requirements for the 2021/22 marketing year (July/June), mostly wheat and rice, are anticipated at a slightly above-average level of 810 000 tonnes. The large import requirements mainly reflect the below-average rice production in 2021 as well as the reduced imports in 2020. The demand for wheat products is forecast at a near-average level, as high international wheat prices are expected to limit the increase in demand.

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Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS, FEWSNET.

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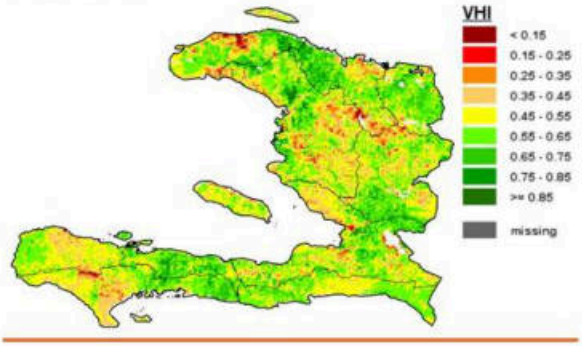
Cereal Production

	2016-2020 average	2020	2021 forecast	change 2021/2020
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	226	180	175	-2.8
Rice (paddy)	173	172	155	-9.5
Sorghum	18	18	20	11.1
Total	418	370	350	-5.2

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet.

Haiti - Vegetation Health Index (VHI)

October 2021



Source: FAO/GIEWS Earth Observation System.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
Haiti

Reference Date: 10-June-2021

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Harvest of 2021 main season maize and paddy crops ongoing**
- **Cereal production in 2020 estimated at below-average level**
- **Cereal import requirements anticipated at above-average levels in 2020/21**
- **Prices of staple food on rising during first four months of 2021**
- **Low food availability and access affect about 4.4 million people**

Harvest of 2021 main season maize and paddy crops ongoing

The harvest of the 2021 main *printemps* season maize and paddy crops has recently started in June. Current crop conditions are generally favourable (NDVI anomaly map) as abundant seasonal rains in March and April favoured crop emergence and development. However, precipitation amounts in May were below average, especially in the minor producing southern and northern areas. Despite favourable weather conditions at planting time, the extent of the area sown was constrained by costly and scarce agricultural inputs. With the aim to increase farmers' access to inputs, the government introduced price ceilings on fertilizers in November 2020 amid the increasing inflation rate. Other efforts to increase crop yields include the inauguration of a hydro-electric dam in the North-East Department in May 2021 and the cleaning of some irrigation canals.

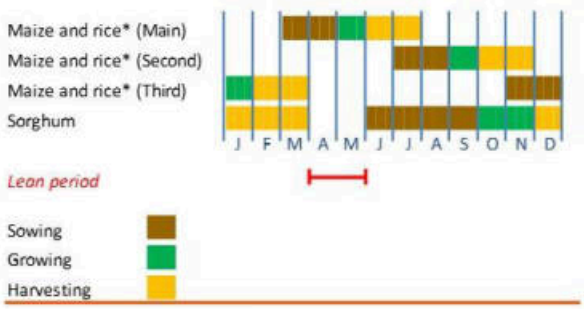
In the July-September period, the weather forecast indicates a high likelihood of above-average precipitation amounts, reducing soil moisture deficit and providing conducive conditions for the 2021 minor *automne* season crops.

Cereal production in 2020 estimated at below-average level

Although official data is not yet available, the 2020 cereal output is estimated at 370 000 tonnes, nearly 10 percent below the previous five-year average. The low level of production mainly reflects limited precipitation amounts from April to July 2020, which affected the main season maize and paddy crops, and the limited access to seeds and other agricultural inputs due to economic constraints.

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Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS, FEWSNET.

Haiti

Cereal Production

	2015-2019 average	2019	2020 estimate	change 2020/2019
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	212	195	180	-7.5
Rice (paddy)	165	177	172	-2.9
Sorghum	20	17	18	7.8
Total	397	388	370	-4.8

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
Haiti

Reference Date: 05-June-2020

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Plantings of 2020 main season expected to decline due to poor access to agricultural inputs and dry weather conditions**
- **Cereal production in 2019 affected by prolonged dry weather conditions**
- **Cereal import requirements forecast at average levels in 2019/20**
- **Prices of staple food higher than year-earlier levels**
- **Lower availability of food and poor access to food affect more than 4 million people**

Plantings of 2020 main season expected to decline due to poor access to agricultural inputs and dry weather conditions

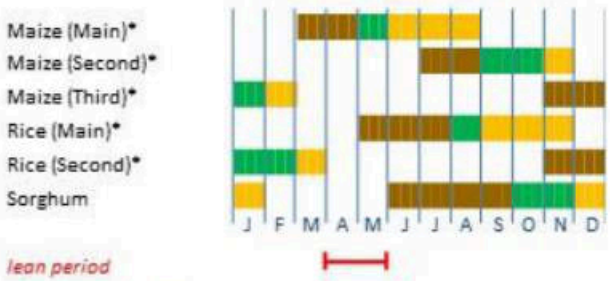
Planting of the 2020 main season maize and bean crops is ongoing and delays were reported across the country due to soil moisture deficits, caused by the irregular and reduced rainfall amounts received during the previous months. During the March-May period, the major producing departments of Artibonite, Ouest and Centre received well below-average rainfall that has resulted in poor vegetation conditions (see VHI map). Yield prospects are likely to improve as weather forecasts point to average precipitation amounts during the June-August period that coincides with the key vegetative and reproductive stages of the main maize crop.

Planting of the main rice season for 2020 is also ongoing in the key producing Artibonite Department at a slow pace due to the limited availability of irrigation water. Favourable rainfall is forecast to improve during the June-August period, likely benefitting crop development.

Sowings of the maize and rice crops are forecast to decline for the second consecutive year as access to agricultural inputs continues worsening mainly due to the sustained increase in inflation rates and the weaker currency. The Haitian gourde started to depreciate in mid-2018 and, as of April 2020, had lost more than 45 percent of its value against the US dollar compared to the same month in 2018. The high level of social insecurity, coupled with restriction measures due to the COVID-19 outbreak, is also likely to affect agricultural activities, hampering the movements of agricultural workers and the transportation of goods, including agricultural inputs.

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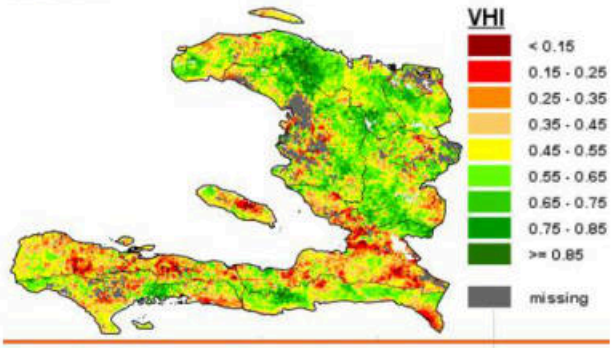
Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS, FEWSNET.

Haiti - Vegetation Health Index (VHI)

May 2020



Source: FAO/GIEWS Earth Observation System.

In order to support agricultural production of the ongoing main season, FAO has distributed seeds of beans and cereals, agricultural inputs as well as provided technical assistance to 9 900 households in the departments of Nord-Est, Nord-Ouest, Nippes and Grand-Anse. An additional 6 600 households will also benefit at the start of the second summer season in July. Similarly, the World Bank and the Inter-American Development Bank have provided support to the Ministry of Agriculture with the provision of in-kind agricultural inputs.

Cereal production in 2019 affected by prolonged dry weather conditions

The 2019 cereal output is estimated at 462 000 tonnes, slightly above the low five-year average that includes the production obtained in 2014 and 2015 that were severely affected by drought. The limited precipitation amounts from April to August 2019 affected the main and second seasons maize crops as well as the main season rice crop, contributing to a year-on-year decline in production by about 10 percent. The economic hardship exacerbated the contraction of the 2019 harvests, due to limited access by farmers to seeds and other agricultural inputs. The extended protests in 2019 that caused the closure of businesses and public services as well as the blockage of roads hindered agricultural and economic activities.

Cereal import requirements forecast at average levels in 2019/20

The cereal import requirements for the 2019/20 marketing year (July/June) are forecast at an above-average level of 805 000 tonnes, mostly wheat and rice. Imports of rice are also forecast at high levels, reflecting the yearly contraction in rice output.

Prices of staple food higher than year-earlier levels

Prices of locally produced rice and black beans increased sharply for the second consecutive month in April due to hoarding and massive buying amid the COVID-19 pandemic. By contrast, prices of imported rice started to decrease from December 2019 and were stable in April 2020, mainly reflecting larger imports during the first quarter of 2020 compared to the same period of the previous year. Overall, prices of staple food in April 2020 remained above those of a year earlier, underpinned by the low maize and rice production in 2019 as well as high production costs, supported by a weak currency.

Lower availability of food and poor access to food affect more than 4 million people

According to the latest Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC) analysis, about 4.1 million people (40 percent of the population analysed) are forecast to be severely food insecure during the lean season period, from March to June 2020. The high levels of food insecurity reflect problems of both availability and access to food. The worst situations are reported in the departments of Grand-Anse, Nord-Ouest and Ouest and the Cité Soleil Commune in Port-au-Prince, which are classified under IPC phase 4 “Emergency.” In 2020, the agricultural and livelihood interventions by humanitarian partners are expected to address the needs of approximately 420 000 beneficiaries, mostly in IPC phase 4 “Emergency” and representing about 10 percent of the total population in need of urgent assistance.

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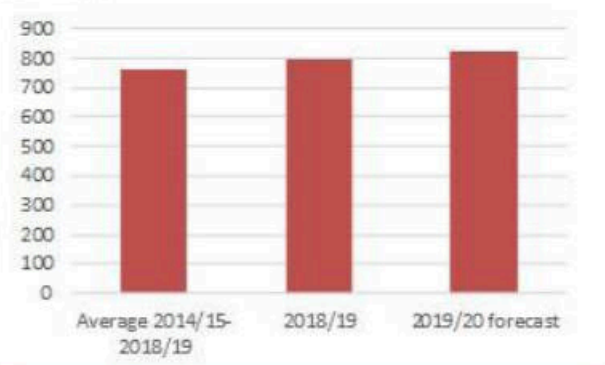
Cereal Production

	2015-2019 average	2019	2020 forecast	change 2020/2019
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	222	220	210	-4.5
Rice (paddy)	169	177	172	-2.8
Sorghum	53	65	60	-7.7
Total	444	462	442	-4.3

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet.

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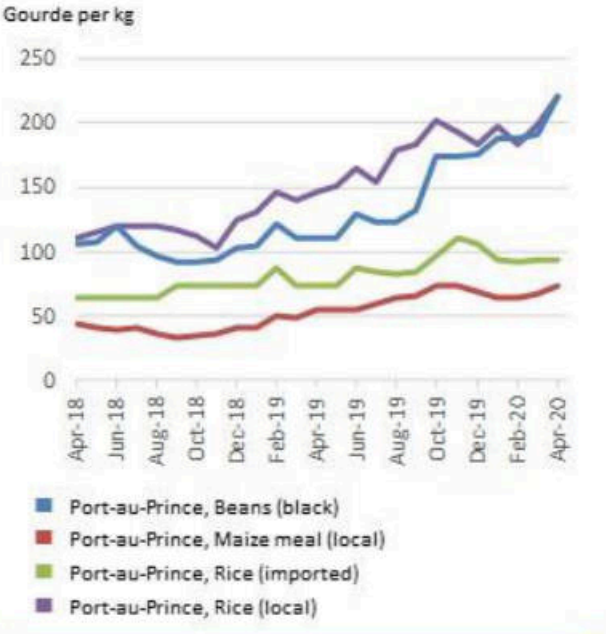
Cereals Imports



Note: Includes rice in milled terms. Split year refers to individual crop marketing years (for rice, calendar year of second year shown).
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets.

Haiti

Selected retail prices



Source: FAO/GIEWS Food Price Monitoring and Analysis Tool.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
Haiti

Reference Date: 31-July-2019

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Dry conditions in 2019 main season adversely affect maize yields**
- **Cereal import requirements forecast at above-average levels in 2019/20**
- **Prices of staple food higher than their year-earlier levels**

Dry conditions in 2019 main season adversely affect maize yields

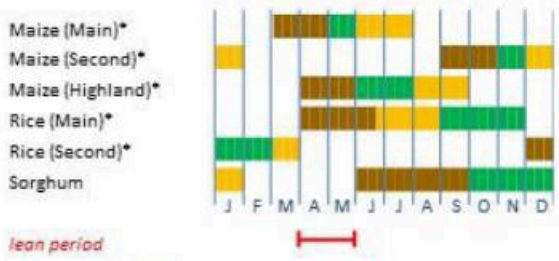
Harvesting of the 2019 main "*printemps*" season maize crop is ongoing, except in the central plateau region, where harvesting operations start in August. After an early onset of rains in March, rainfall amounts during the planting and crop development stages were below average, particularly in the Southern and Northern regions. Field reports by the FAO Haiti Office indicate drought conditions in North-East Department, where moisture deficits affected the 2019 main maize crops and pasture availability. This is supported by satellite images that show below-average vegetation health conditions in Southwestern and Northern regions (see VHI map). Poor rainy seasons for the second consecutive year are expected to further aggravate the food security situation in these regions. By contrast, according to remote sensing analyses, vegetation conditions are deemed favourable in some areas of major maize producing departments, such as Artibonite, Centre and Sud-Est, which account for more than 50 percent of the national production. Prospects for the main season output remain uncertain due to the prolonged dryness.

The 2019 main rice crop is currently at development stage and rainfall amounts and distribution were generally favourable in the key rice producing Artibonite Department. Remote sensing analysis suggests above-average vegetation conditions in the region, raising yields prospects.

Although there is no official data, plantings of maize and rice crops are estimated to have contracted in the main season and are expected to continue its downturn in the following minor season due to high production costs, consequence of a weaker local currency and high inflationary pressures. Poor macro-economic situations could have severe impacts on the effective purchasing power of the poor, which in turn would likely affect their food insecurity situations.

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Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS, FEWSNET.

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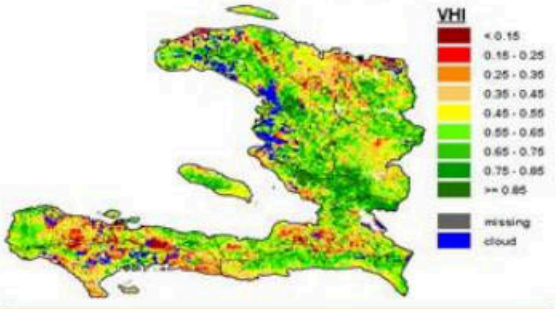
Cereal Production

	2014-2018 average	2018	2019 forecast	change 2019/2018
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	206	260	250	-3.8
Rice (paddy)	164	183	180	-1.6
Sorghum	49	70	60	-14.3
Total	419	513	490	-4.5

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet.

Haiti - Vegetation Health Index (VHI)

From start of season 1 to dekad 1, July 2019



Source: FAO/GIEWS Earth Observation System.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
Haiti

Reference Date: 03-December-2018

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Cereal production in 2018 estimated slightly above average**
- **Cereal import requirements forecast at above-average levels in 2018/19**
- **Prices of imported rice high due to a weak currency**

Cereal production in 2018 estimated slightly higher than average

The 2018 aggregate cereal production is forecast at 564 000 tonnes, slightly above the previous five-year average.

Harvesting of the main season maize crop was completed in August and production is estimated at 185 000 tonnes, 13 percent lower than the previous five-year average. Despite favourable rainfalls in April and May, limited rainfall in June negatively affected crop development and lowered yields. The dryness reduced production on a yearly basis especially in rainfed Artibonite and Centre departments, which together account to about one-third of the annual production. By contrast, maize production is expected to surpass last year's levels in Sud, Nippes and Grand-Anse departments, where crops were less affected by dry weather conditions.

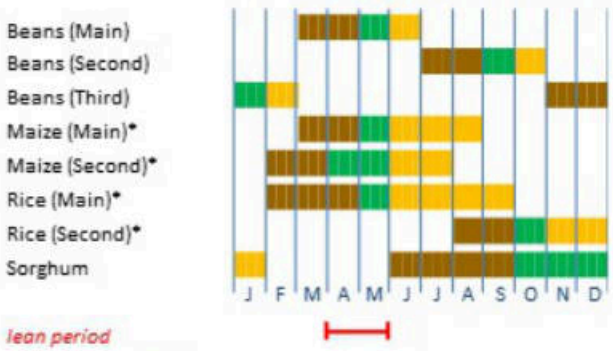
The harvest of the 2018 main season rice crop finalized in September and production is estimated at 183 000 tonnes, 13 percent above the five-year average. High yields have been reported in the main rice producing Artibonite Deparment, which contributes to about 90 percent of the total production, due to the improved irrigation system and infrastructure repairs funded by the governmental programme "Caravan of Change."

Cereal import requirements forecast at above-average levels in 2018/19

The cereal import requirements for the 2018/19 marketing year (July/June) are forecast at a well above-average level of 835 000 tonnes, reflecting increased wheat demand. The country depends entirely on trade to cover its local needs of wheat grain and flour, and imports increased considerably in 2017/18. As domestic demand is expected to remain high, wheat and wheat flour import requirements in 2018/19 are set at a well above-average level of 330 000 tonnes.

Haiti

Crop Calendar (*major foodcrop)



Source: FAO/GIEWS, FEWSNET.

Haiti

Cereal Production

	2013-2017 average	2017	2018 estimate	change 2018/2017
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	213	225	185	-17.8
Rice (paddy)	161	179	183	2.2
Sorghum	56	80	70	-12.5
Total	430	484	438	-9.5

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheet.

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
Haiti

Reference Date: 09-November-2017

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Uncertain prospects for 2017 cereal production**
- **Cereal imports forecast at high level for 2017/18 marketing year**
- **Prices for main staples mixed in September and higher than a year earlier**

Uncertain prospects for 2017 cereal production

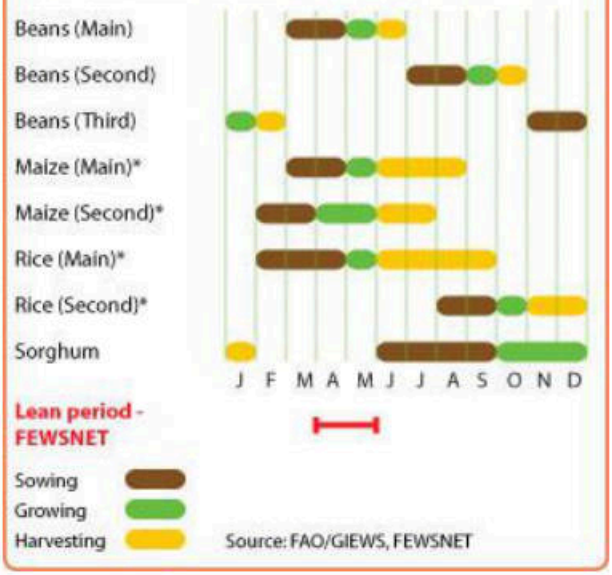
Cereal output for 2017 is uncertain. An abnormal distribution of precipitation levels characterized the 2017 spring season, concluded in August, which accounts for 60 percent of the cereal output. This is the fourth consecutive spring season since 2013, where rainfall levels deviate from their long-term average. The 2017 spring season had both excess rains as well as significant dry periods. Maize production for the 2017 spring season is anticipated at 15 percent below its level from the same season a year earlier. Sorghum output during the spring season is estimated at 18 percent below its 2016 level for the season. In September, Hurricane Irma, a category five event, caused excess precipitation in the Nord, Nord-Ouest, Nord-Est departments. According to official assessments, the area affected by excess precipitation for autumn season maize and rice, which is harvested from late November, ranges between 30 and 40 percent of the area sown. FAO is supporting the Government's efforts in providing inputs, particularly seed and fertilizers, for replanting crops in the most affected areas.

FAO anticipates that 2017 maize and sorghum output may decline by 13 and 17 percent, respectively, compared to 2016. By contrast, 2017 rice output is expected to increase by about 10 percent as the spring crop is estimated at above last year's level and the autumn crop, impacted by Hurricane Irma, represents less than 10 percent of the annual output. If output is close to 2016's levels for the remaining seasons, the aggregate 2017 cereal output is anticipated to reach 430 000 tonnes, about 4 percent below the 2016 levels, but still above the average of the last five years that were significantly affected by the El Niño phenomena.

Cereal imports forecast at high levels for 2017/18 marketing year

Cereal import requirements for the 2017/18 marketing year (July/June), which include both commercial imports and food aid, are anticipated at 705 000 tonnes, slightly below their record levels in the previous marketing year, but still well above

Haiti
Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



Haiti
Cereal production

	2012-2016 average	2016	2017 forecast	change 2017/2016
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	208	252	220	-13
Rice (paddy)	155	172	190	10
Sorghum	59	24	20	-17
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	422	448	430	-4

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

GIEWS Country Brief
Haiti

Reference Date: 04-October-2016

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Good prospects for 2016 main spring season crops**
- **Cereal imports forecast to remain high in 2016/17 marketing year**
- **Prices for cereals were stable or declined in September with main season harvest**
- **Hurricane Matthew to severely impact Haiti**

Good prospects for 2016 main spring season crops

The harvest of the main 2016 spring season crops is virtually concluded and the outcome has been good reflecting a return to generally average to above-average rainfall following the dissipation of the 2014-2015 El Niño phenomenon. Planting of the second season crops (except maize) will be concluded in October. Prospects are uncertain, as excess humidity and flash floods from Hurricane Matthew may impact planting operations. However, at this early stage, assuming plantings are completed unimpaired and weather conditions are normal throughout the season, cereal production in 2016 is tentatively anticipated to recover strongly from the two years of drought-reduced outputs and reach 510 000 tonnes, around the average level prior to the latest El Niño event. The anticipated increase in output mainly reflects a strong recovery which expected in maize and sorghum production, while that of rice is forecast to remain close to last year's level.

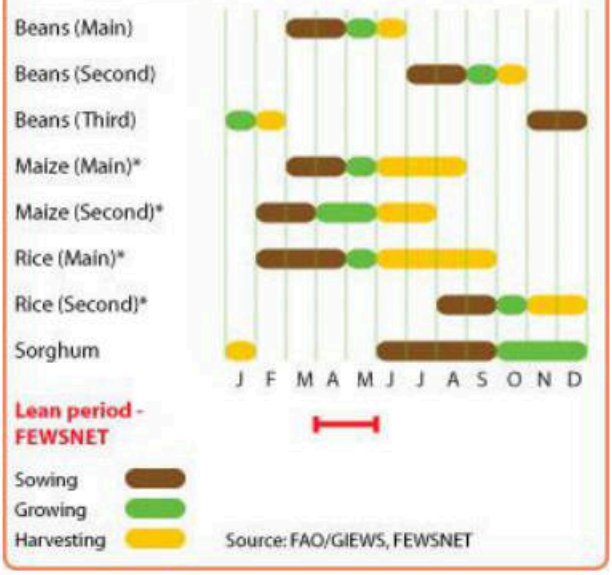
Cereal imports forecast to remain high in 2016/17 marketing year

Cereal imports in the 2016/17 marketing year (July/June) are forecast at 650 000 tonnes, 3 percent below the previous year's record level. The only moderate decline in imports, despite the significantly larger domestic production expected in 2016, mainly reflects the lingering impact of two years of drought-reduced outputs on local supplies, particularly for maize and rice.

Prices for cereals were stable or declined in September with main season harvest

September prices for rice, the country's main staple food which is mostly imported from the United States of America, remained unchanged or slightly declined, reflecting ample supplies from imports and low quotations in the international market.

Haiti
Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



Haiti
Cereal production

	2011-2015 average	2015	2016 forecast	change 2016/2015
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	229	110	340	209
Rice (paddy)	158	137	130	-5
Sorghum	83	32	83	159
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	471	279	553	98

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief
Haiti

Reference Date: 30-December-2015

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Cereal production in 2015 was further curtailed by severe dry weather**
- **Cereal imports forecast at a record high in 2015/16 marketing year**
- **Rice prices declined but maize and bean prices surged in November**

Cereal production in 2015 fell for the second consecutive year

FAO estimates the 2015 cereal production at 353 000 tonnes, 4 percent down from the 2014 drought-reduced level and significantly below the five-year average. This is the result of the severe and prolonged dry weather associated with the prevailing strong El Niño. Most of the decline concerns maize and rice. Preliminary official estimates point to a reduction in the area planted to cereals of at least 50 percent, largely in the main producing regions of the Central Plateau and South-East. In the North-West and North-East, chronically dry and low production regions, total loss of crops and livestock have also been reported.

Cereal imports forecast at a record for 2015/16 marketing year

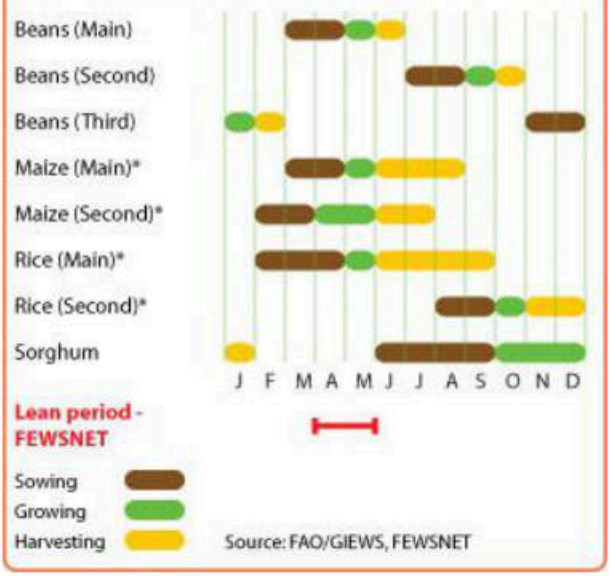
Cereal imports in the 2015/16 marketing year are forecast at a record level of 698 000 tonnes, driven up largely by an expected significant increase in wheat and rice imports. Imports of maize are also forecast to increase, and although maize accounts for a relatively small amount of overall cereal imports, maintaining supplies in rural areas where it is an important food is critical. Attaining the necessary quantities of additional maize imports in the current marketing year will be made difficult by the drought-reduced availability also in the Dominican Republic, the country's main supplier.

Rice prices declined while maize and bean prices surged in November

Prices of main staple imported rice, sourced mainly from the United States of America, declined in most markets in November, reversing the increases of the previous month. The declining trend reflects lower quotations in the international market.

By contrast, prices of domestically-produced maize meal surged in several markets in November, with monthly increases ranging from 10 to 33 percent. Prices in November were significantly above their levels at the same time last year, particularly in Jeremie, the main market in the southwest of the country. Similarly, in the Capitol, Port-au-Prince, and Hinche markets, price increases were recorded for black beans, which on average were well above their values a year earlier. Prices were underpinned by this year's severely reduced production.

Haiti
Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*

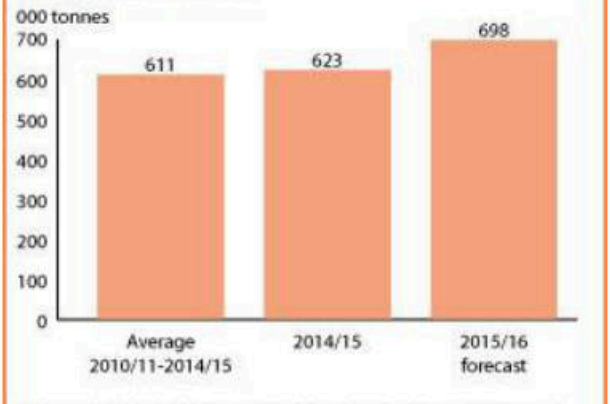


Haiti
Cereal production

	2010-2014 average	2014	2015 forecast	change 2015/2014
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	279	160	135	-16
Rice (paddy)	146	125	105	-16
Sorghum	113	82	113	38
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	538	367	353	-4

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

Haiti
Total cereal imports



Notes: Total cereal includes rice in milled terms. Split year refers to individual crop marketing years.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief
Haiti

Reference Date: 27-May-2015

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- **Uncertain prospects for first main 2015 cereal season due to El Niño conditions**
- **Higher cereal imports forecast in 2014/15 marketing year (July/June)**
- **Maize prices increase in main markets, rice prices remain stable**

Uncertain prospects for first main 2015 cereal season due to El Niño conditions

Planting of the main "*de printemps*" season is virtually concluded. Official estimates of the area planted are not yet available. However, sowings may have been significantly reduced due to below average rainfall in most of the country, and in particular the main producing area of Artibonite and low availability of seeds due to last year's reduced production. The reduced rainfall levels reflect the ongoing El Niño conditions. In March 2015, the threshold conditions for a weak El Niño (ENSO) event were reached. The consensus of ENSO prediction models indicate that these conditions, which are associated with dry weather and high temperatures in Haiti, could continue and strengthen toward mid-2015.

At this early stage in the season, FAO preliminarily projects cereal production for 2015 at average levels, as the effects of the El Niño event on crops are still unclear, but this projection may not materialize if rains do not recover in the remaining of the season.

Higher cereal imports forecast in 2014/15 marketing year (July/June)

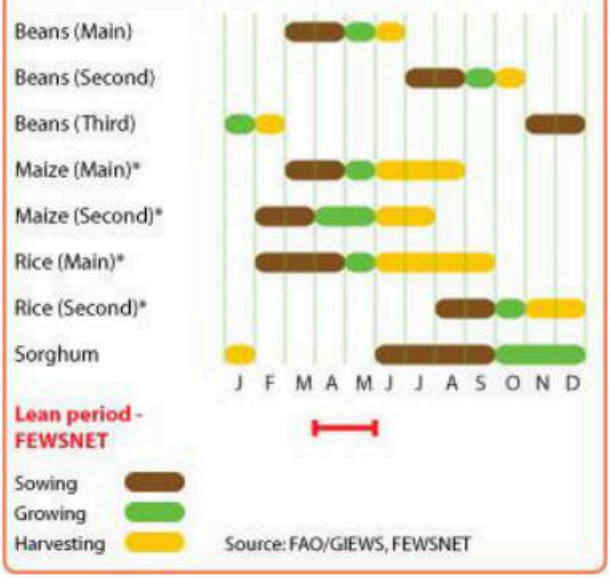
Cereal imports in the 2014/15 marketing year (July/June) are forecast at 710 000 tonnes, 6 percent above last year's above average level. The increase mainly reflects higher imports of rice and maize, as a result of the sharp drop in 2014 production.

Maize prices increase in May in main markets, rice prices remain stable

Prices of main staple imported rice, which represents more than 80 percent of domestic consumption, remained stable in most markets following trends in prices from the United States of America, the country's main supplier. Prices were unchanged from their levels of a year earlier.

By contrast, maize meal prices, the second most important staple, increased in major markets and remained well above their year-earlier levels as a result of the reduced 2014 output.

Haiti
Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



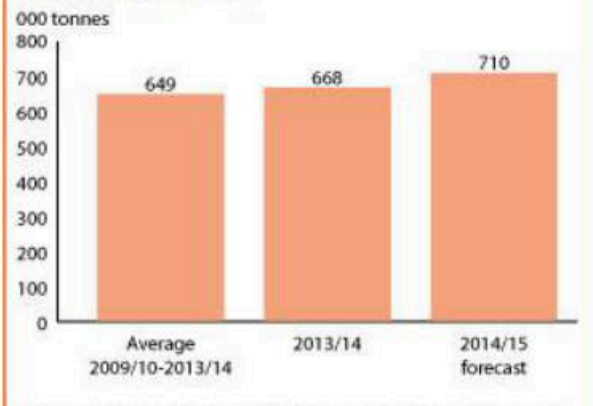
Source: FAO/GIEWS, FEWSNET

Haiti
Cereal production

	2010-2014 average	2014	2015 forecast	change 2015/2014
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	282	160	282	76
Rice (paddy)	146	125	126	1
Sorghum	113	82	113	38
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	541	367	521	42

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

Haiti
Total cereal imports



Notes: Total cereal includes rice in milled terms. Split year refers to individual crop marketing years.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief
Haiti

Reference Date: 02-December-2014

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- 2014 cereal production forecast at sharply reduced levels
- Higher cereal imports forecast in 2014/15 marketing year (July/June)
- Rice and maize meal prices remained unchanged and at low levels in November

2014 cereal production forecast at sharply reduced levels

Official estimates of the 2014 cereal season output have been revised sharply downwards. This follows unseasonal dry weather from June through August which affected the 2014 spring season's cereal crops, the most important for maize which is rainfed, and the summer crops, mainly rice. Cereal production in 2014 is expected to decrease by 40 percent and reach 367 000 tonnes.

Preliminary assessments point to 16 000 families being affected by the drop in production in the Central Plateu, North-West, South-East and Western regions of the country. These families are currently being assisted by WFP with cash-for-work programmes, the Haitian Government with food vouchers and by other UN agencies.

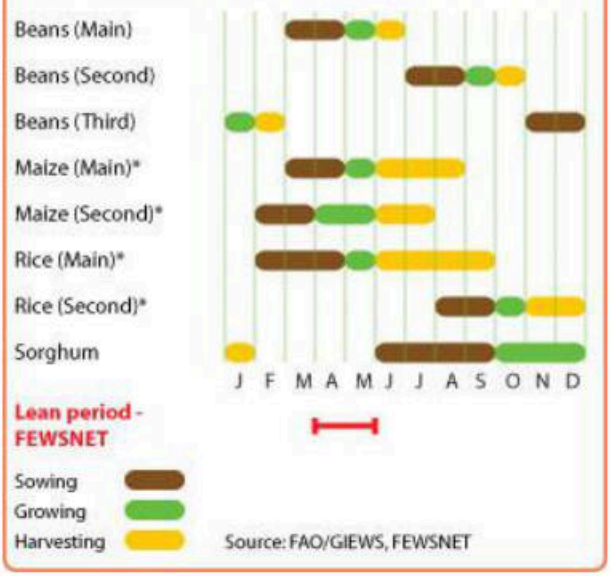
Higher cereal imports forecast in 2014/15 marketing year (July/June)

Cereal imports in the 2014/15 marketing year (July/June) are forecast at 705 000 tonnes, 7 percent above last year's near-average level. The increase mainly reflects higher imports of rice and maize which are expected to increase by 8 and 18 percent, respectively, from last year as a result of the sharp drop in this year's production.

Rice and maize meal prices remained unchanged and at low levels in November

Prices of main staple imported rice, which represents more than 80 percent of domestic consumption, remained stable in most markets and declined in the capital, Port-au-Prince, in US dollars, following trends in prices from the United States of America, the country's main supplier. Prices were unchanged or below their levels of a year earlier. Local maize meal prices, the second most important staple, remained stable in most markets and were below their levels from November 2013, in spite of a sharp reduction in 2014 maize production.

Haiti
Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*

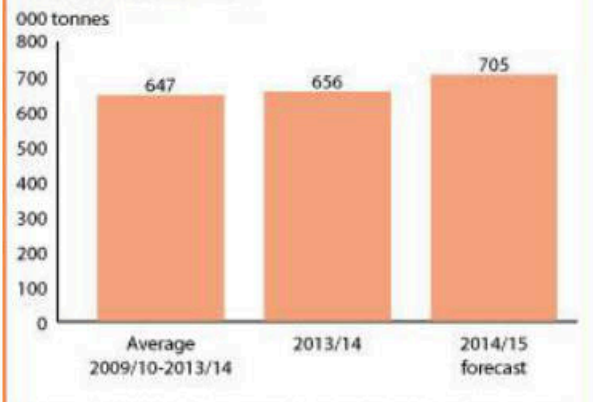


Haiti
Cereal production

	2009-2013 average	2013	2014 forecast	change 2014/2013
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	311	335	160	-52
Rice (paddy)	146	169	125	-26
Sorghum	121	108	82	-24
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	578	612	367	-40

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

Haiti
Total cereal imports



Notes: Total cereal includes rice in milled terms. Split year refers to individual crop marketing years.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief
Haiti

Reference Date: 09-April-2014

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Drought affecting food security in the Northwest region
- More rains needed for planting of the 2014 main season cereal crop
- Cereal imports forecast to remain high in the 2013/14 marketing year (July/June)
- Rice and maize meal prices remain stable in March

Drought affecting food security in the Northwest region

Well below-average precipitation from November to March has resulted in crop losses of the 2013/14 "autumn" season, mainly sorghum, beans and maize, in high altitude areas and prevented farmers from planting in low-lying parts. Although the impact of the reduced output in the region in the 2013 national production is not significant, the Northwest region is one of the most vulnerable regions in the country, with 43 percent of household suffering from food insecurity and high rates of chronic malnutrition. In order to assist the drought-affected population, the Government of Haiti and the United Nations have launched a joint appeal for international support. The World Food Programme (WFP) has recently distributed 1 500 tonnes of food to approximately 164 000 people, mainly women and children. In addition, the Ministry of Agriculture also provided 6 000 seed kits. Additional emergency assistance is still needed, in particular with agricultural inputs for planting of the 2014 main season crop which has just started with improved precipitation in late March.

More rains needed for planting of the 2014 main season cereal crop

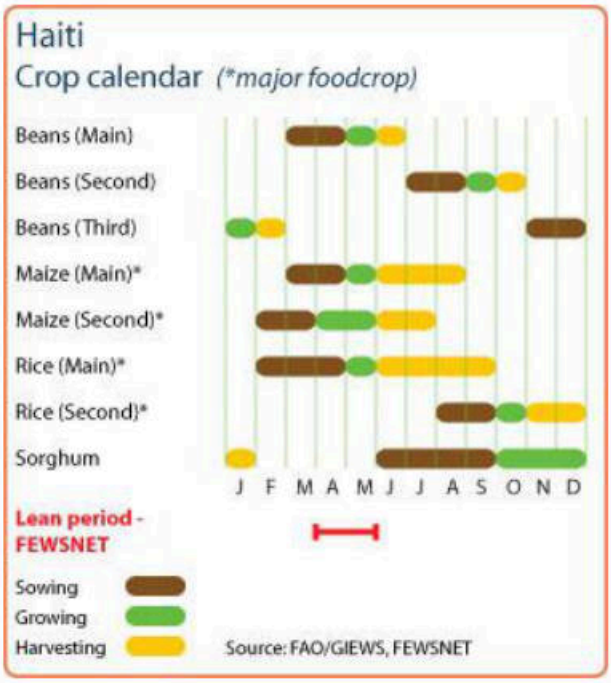
In the main producing regions of Artibonite and West, planting of the 2014 main "spring" season cereal crops, mainly maize, is well advanced. Remote sensing data indicate below-average precipitation in February and March, which delayed planting. More rain is needed to avoid significant reduction of yield potential this season.

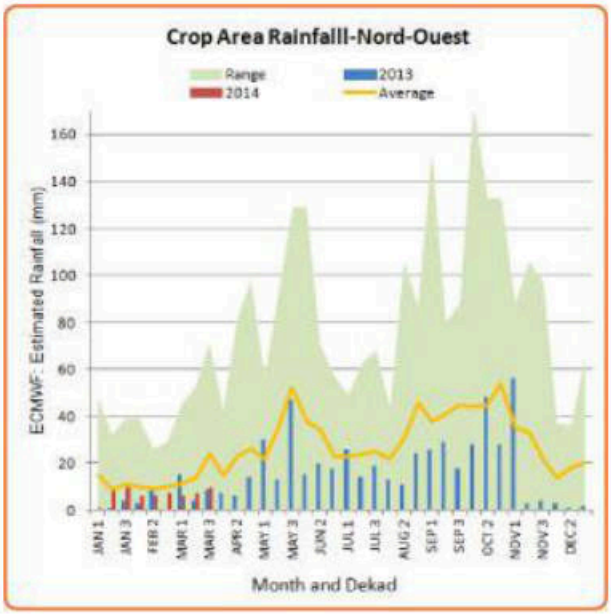
Recovery in 2013 cereal output

The 2013 cereal production (main and second seasons) was estimated at 540 000 tonnes, or 35 percent up on the previous year's sharply-reduced level. This mainly reflects a recovery in yields of maize, rice and sorghum due to favourable weather during the cropping season, in particular the absence of tropical storms and flooding.

Cereal imports forecast to remain high in the 2013/14 marketing year (July/June)

Despite the 2013 good cereal production, imports in the 2013/14 marketing year (July/June) are forecast at 706 000 tonnes, unchanged from the previous year's level but 5 percent higher than the five-year average. The increase reflects greater wheat imports, which are forecast to reach their pre-earthquake levels of





Haiti

Cereal production

	2008-2012 average	2012	2013 estimate	change 2013/2012
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	286	202	289	43
Rice (paddy)	128	116	130	12
Sorghum	120	92	121	32
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	534	410	540	32

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

Haiti

Reference Date: 01-October-2013

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- The 2013 main season cereal production recovers from last year's low level
- Maize meal prices decline with the new harvest while rice prices remain stable

The 2013 main season cereal production recovers from last year's low level

The harvest of the 2013 main (spring) cereal season was completed in September. This season accounts for about half of the annual production of cereals, mainly maize and sorghum, but only a third of the rice output. Despite below average precipitation during the sowing period, the absence of tropical storms and flooding this season has resulted in a recovery of maize yields. Preliminary official estimates point to an increase of 30 percent in production from last year's sharply reduced level. Rice production is also estimated improved. Planting of the secondary season has begun under favourable weather conditions. Assuming favourable weather in the remaining of the secondary season, the 2013 aggregate cereal production is expected to increase 35 percent from last year to above average levels.

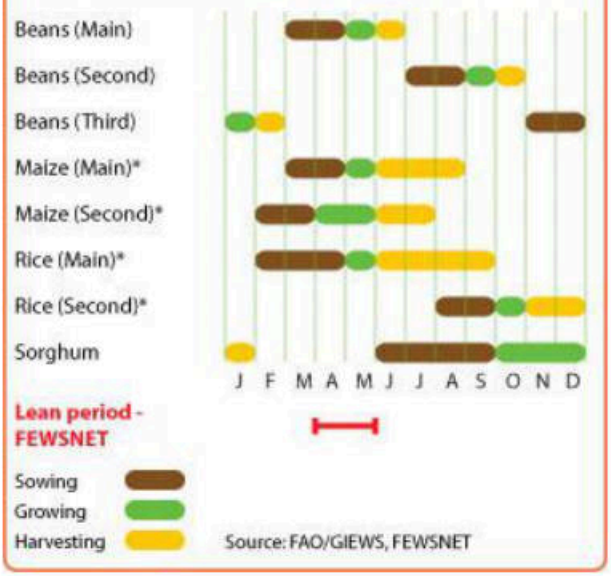
Maize meal prices decline as new harvest arrives while rice prices remain stable

With the arrival of the new harvest into the markets, prices of local maize meal—an important staple—have declined in recent months. In Port-au-Prince and Jacmel, prices for maize meal in September were at the same level or lower than a year earlier. In remote areas, such as Jeremie and Hinche, prices were higher than in September 2012 due to access difficulties.

Prices of imported rice the main staple in the country—remained stable in most markets in September, with the exception of Port-au-Prince where they declined almost 8 percent. However, following trends of the United States export rice prices, domestic price remains higher than at the same time in 2012. By contrast, prices for locally produced rice are lower than a year earlier reflecting the recent harvest.

Haiti

Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



Haiti

Cereal production

	2008-2012 average	2012	2013 forecast	change 2013/2012
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	286	202	289	43
Rice (paddy)	128	106	130	23
Sorghum	120	92	121	32
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	534	400	540	35

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

Haiti

Reference Date: 17-August-2012

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Dry weather conditions sharply reduced the 2012 spring season cereal crops
- Prices of imported rice stable while those of maize decline in some markets
- Food security remains difficult

Dry weather conditions sharply reduced the 2012 spring season cereal crops

Harvesting of the 2012 spring season's cereal crops, which normally accounts for about half of the annual maize output and approximately 30 percent for rice, is underway. Dry weather conditions during the growing period in May and early June had a negative impact on yields, particularly maize, which is mainly rainfed and the output is anticipated to be well below the good level of the same season in 2011.

Planting of the main season rice crop is ongoing in the central Artibonite irrigated plains. Water supplies are estimated adequate, but high prices of fertilizers and low availability of agricultural inputs may reduce plantings.

The 2012 aggregate maize production (spring and summer crops) is expected at 280 000 tonnes, 20 percent below the high level of 2011, while rice production is tentatively forecast at 120 000 tonnes, similar to last year's level.

Rice prices stable while those of maize decline in some markets

In most markets, prices of the main staple imported rice remained relatively stable in the past months and in July were around or below their levels of a year ago.

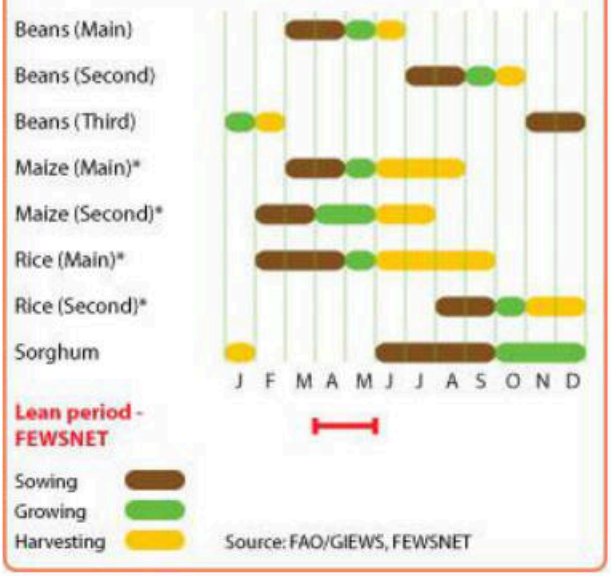
Prices of locally produced maize showed marked declines in the past months in some markets as a result of the arrival of the spring harvest into the markets, but remained firm in the capital city Port-au-Prince. In general, prices in July were below or close to their levels at the same time a year ago. Maize prices are expected to increase in the next months as a result of the spring season reduced production.

Food security remains difficult

The ongoing 2012 spring season cereal harvest, although reduced, has increased availabilities of locally produced crops and lowered prices improving somewhat food security situation. Latest official reports indicate a decline in the number of new cholera since the beginning of July. However, despite the number of cases this summer has not been as high as in 2011, still 377 deaths and some 45 000 cases were reported in the last three months. The Government expects cholera cases to increase with the cyclone season.

Haiti

Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



Haiti

Cereal production

	2007-2011 average	2011	2012 forecast	change 2012/2011
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	300	349	280	-20
Rice (paddy)	126	120	120	0
Sorghum	125	138	115	-17
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	551	607	515	-15

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

Haiti

Reference Date: 21-February-2012

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Cereal production in 2011 above average
- Prices of imported rice decline
- Food security improves but situation remains difficult

Poor start of the rains of the 2012 spring cereal season

Sowing of the 2012 spring season's cereal crops –rice and maize- normally starts in February/March but below average rains during January and February may delay field activities. Although rice cultivation is irrigated in the main valleys, low precipitation is likely to affect rain fed areas.

Cereal harvest in 2011 above average but below the previous year's record output

Total cereal 2011 production is estimated some 19 percent above the average of the last five years, although about 7 percent below the bumper levels in 2010. The decrease in output is the result of prolonged dry weather since the beginning of the season which delayed plantings of the 2011 main season crops and reduced yields. The departments most affected by dry conditions were the North, Northwest, Northeast and High Central Plateau.

Maize, the most important domestically produced cereal, is mainly a rain fed crop. The insufficient precipitation mainly affected the 2011 main spring season (March/August), which accounts for half of the annual production of maize. Overall, however, production in 2011 remained satisfactory at 349 000 tonnes, 22 percent higher than the average of the last five years. Similarly, production of sorghum in 2011 is estimated below the 2010 bumper crop but about 15 percent above than the average of the last five years. By contrast, rice production in 2011 declined sharply due to low availability of fertilizers and agricultural inputs in both the first and second seasons.

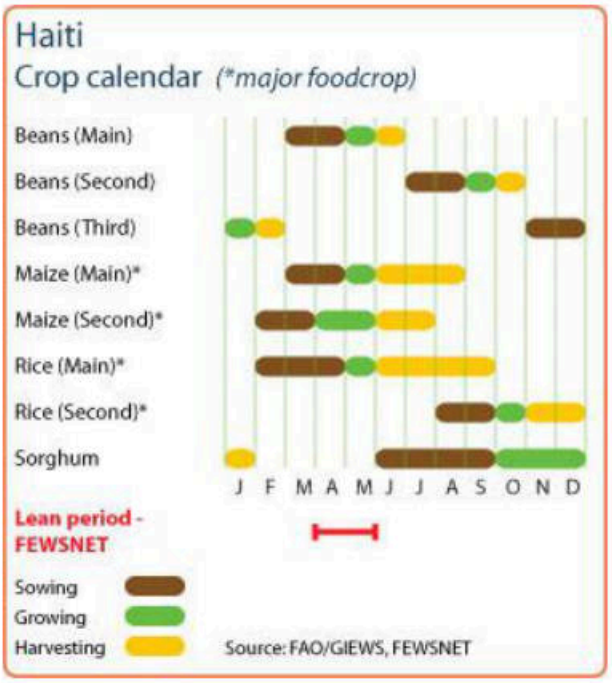
Rice prices declining while those of maize stable

Prices of the main staple imported rice resumed to increase in June and July of last year and remained relatively stable in most of the remaining of the year. Prices declined in most markets in December and January 2012 following trends in the international markets. In the capital city Port-au-Prince, prices of imported rice in January were 20 percent lower than a year ago.

Prices of locally produced maize showed mixed trends in the past months but were stable in most markets and close to their levels in January 2011. Similarly, prices of other locally produced staples, such as sorghum and beans, remained stable in most markets.

Food security improves but situation remains difficult

Following larger availabilities of locally produced crops after the 2011 good harvests and lower prices of imported staples, food security



Haiti

Cereal production

	2006-2010 average	2010	2011 estimate	change 2011/2010
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	271	365	349	-4
Rice (paddy)	124	141	120	-15
Sorghum	118	146	138	-5
Others	0	0	0	0
Total	512	652	607	-7

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

Haiti

Reference Date: 2-November-2010

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Favourable weather conditions support the development of second season grains
- Food security continues to generally improve but monitoring remains necessary in parts of the country
- Prices of imported rice show a steep increase in the last months

A threatening health emergency is faced by Haiti

Haiti is currently facing a worrying cholera outbreak. Official sources estimate the death toll in their hundreds and the cases in their thousands. The emergency is mainly localized in the Artibonite and in the Central departments (Department du Centre) but according to unofficial sources some cases have been also found in the crowded Port-au-Prince.

Favourable weather conditions foster second season food production

Seasonal rains were generally favourable and well distributed allowing the timely onset of the second cropping season. The expected output, although estimates are very preliminary, is considered to be good. Harvesting of the main season rice crop is complete in the central Artibonite irrigated plains (where 60 percent of the total domestic rice is produced), in the plain of Les Cayes and in the small irrigated areas of the North-East department. The irrigated planes have been well supplied with water and inputs. High yield varieties of rice are now well established and widely used by farmers. According to a joint FAO/WFP Crop and Food Security Assessment Mission (CFSAM), summer rice production (the main cropping season) will see an increase of 15 percent compared to the same campaign of previous year.

Harvesting of the main maize crop was also complete in September and estimates point to an above average aggregate output of 258 000 tonnes mainly on account of the good precipitation of the spring rainy season and on the favourable climatic conditions observed to date.

The output of the second season rice and bean crops, the harvest of which is currently underway and will last till the end of November, is expected to be above average as precipitation distribution has been generally favourable.

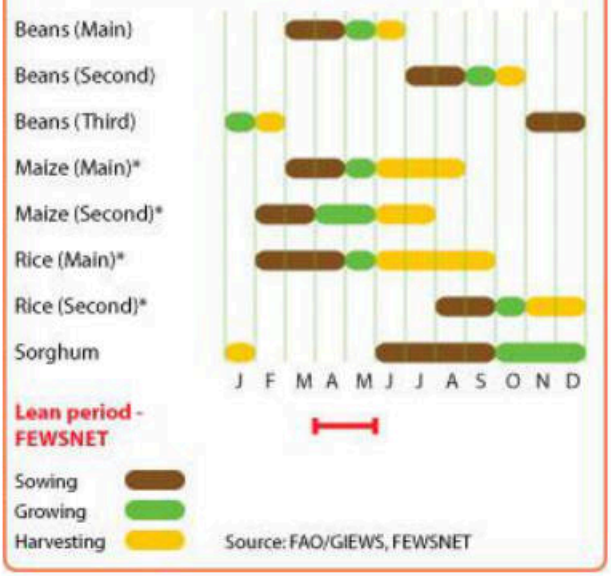
Food security continues to improve but close monitoring is still required in parts

The good performance of the spring cropping season, harvested till last September, and the satisfactory availability of imported commodities on the market at relatively low prices, at least till September, have had a positive impact on the food security situation in the country.

In July, the CFSAM has identified three areas of the country that were facing a critical food situation and would have required close monitoring in the following months such as the North-West, the central plateau and the vulnerable areas of the département de l'Ouest. According to more recent data, highly food insecure areas are restricted to the southern

Haiti

Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



Haiti

Cereal production

	2005-2009 average	2009	2010 forecast	change 2010/2009
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	238	304	258	-15
Rice (paddy)	117	128	132	3
Sorghum	108	121	112	-7
Total	463	553	502	-9

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

Haiti

Reference Date: 17-August-2010

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Abundant and well distributed rains recorded in June/July 2010
- Despite late rains, above average crop forecast in the 2010 spring cropping season
- Price of major staples are back to pre-earthquake levels; maize prices remain higher than in December 2009

Following a late start, the spring rainy season was abundant and beneficial to crops in most of the country

The 2010 spring rainy season started in April/May about 4 to 6 weeks later than normal. Rains were then abundantly above average in June/July, except in the arid North-West mountains, where a poor harvest was also gathered in 2009, the northern regions of the Artibonite department and the areas close to the epicentre of the earthquake in the départemenent de l'Ouest.

Above average foodcrop output expected in 2010; but slightly lower than last year's bumper crop

Planting of the main season rice crop is complete in the central Artibonite irrigated plains, in the plain of Les Cayes and in the small irrigated areas of the North-East department. The irrigated planes have been well supplied with water and inputs (fertilizers, improved seed varieties, credit) compared to the same period in 2009 and this is expected to slightly increase rice production during the current summer season.

Harvesting of the main maize crop is ongoing in the southern and central departments, while maize is still in its vegetative stage in the areas were rainfall was particularly delayed. The late rains resulted in a general reduction of planted area, but output may partly be offset if the good precipitation of June/July continues. Main season pulse crops are also being harvested in the humid highlands.

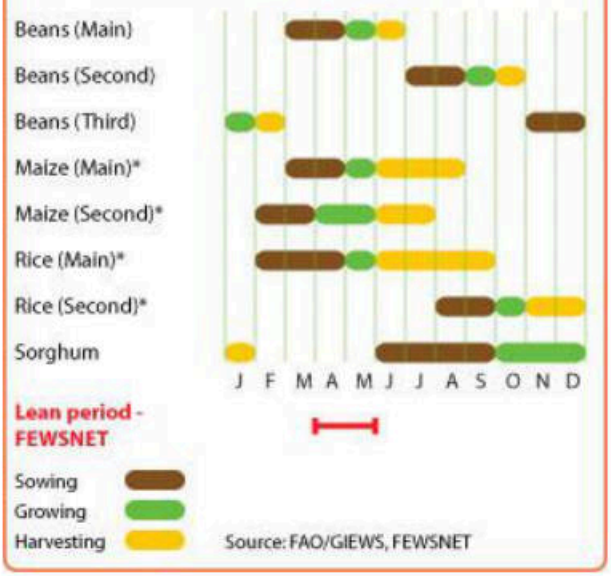
A joint FAO/WFP Crop and Food Security Assessment Mission (CFSAM) visited the country in June-July and a report is being finalized.

Markets are well supplied and prices of most staples are back to pre-earthquake levels

Abundant supplies of both local, as harvesting of some grains has started in several departments, and imported food are pushing down staple food prices, which have now generally returned to their levels prior to the earthquake. In the major market of Port-au-Prince prices of imported rice have been declining in the last few months and at the beginning of August 2010 rice prices were up to 25 percent lower than their levels in February 2010 and 20 percent lower than in July 2008. Similarly, quotations of local rice have also decreased and are in July 14 percent below the level of one year ago. By contrast, despite the good expected 2010 production, prices of maize remain relatively higher than the pre-earthquake level, although a slight decline is observed in the last three months.

Haiti

Crop calendar *(*major foodcrop)*



Haiti

Cereal production

	2005-2009 average	2009	2010 forecast	change 2010/2009
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	238	304	258	-15
Rice (paddy)	117	128	132	3
Sorghum	108	121	112	-7
Total	463	553	502	-9

Note: percentage change calculated from unrounded data.
Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets

GIEWS Country Brief

Haiti

Reference Date: 09-October-2009

FOOD SECURITY SNAPSHOT

- Favourable production prospects reflect an increase in planted area by 15-20 percent for maize, sorghum and beans
- Food insecurity improves across the country
- Declining imported rice and maize prices are still well above 2007 levels, but respectively 40 and 27 percent below 2008 record

Very good 2009 cropping season prospects

The 2009 Atlantic Hurricane season, which runs from June through November, is early forecast to be near or below normal and, to date, no major damage has been recorded.

Harvesting of first season maize has been completed in July-August and planting of the second season crop, to be harvested by the end of the year, is well advanced. Total 2009 production is tentatively forecast at 230 000 tonnes, almost 12 percent compared to the last five years average. This result is mainly due to an increase by 15-20 percent in planted area of maize, beans and sorghum and the positive effects of abundant and well distributed precipitations coupled with Governmental subsidies to input prices and free distribution of seeds. In particular, the quantity of fertilizers distributed between June 2008 and May 2009 has more than doubled if compared to the past.

Harvest of the important irrigated paddy crop has been also completed, while the rainfed crop harvest is still underway.

Preliminary estimates point to a rice production of 60 000 tonnes.

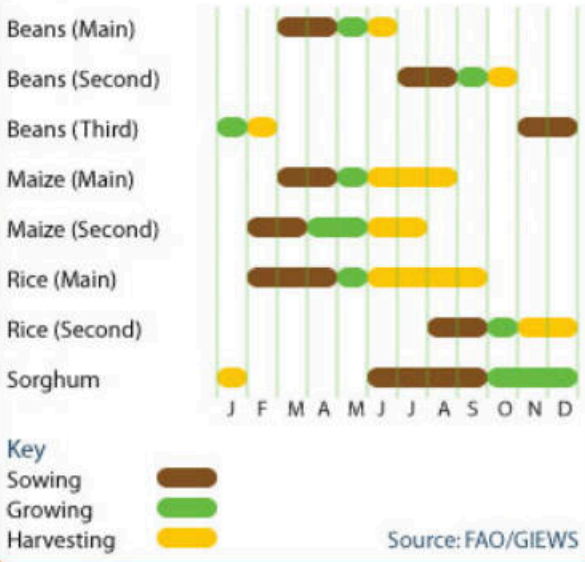
Food security improves across the country

According to the Coordination Nationale de la Sécurité Alimentaire (CNSA) by the end of July, the population with food insecurity is officially estimated in 1.9 millions, with a 25 percent decrease from the last trimester's estimates. This positive trend is essentially the result of the very good production of 2008 winter staple foods (in particular maize and beans), the gradual reduction in market prices and the implementation of safety net programs based on donor or government-financed labor-intensive works. However, most food vulnerable groups are still in the poorest urban slums as well as in the departments of North-West, Artibonite, South-East, Nippes, South and the Grand'Anse.

Rice prices continue to decline, but remain quite high

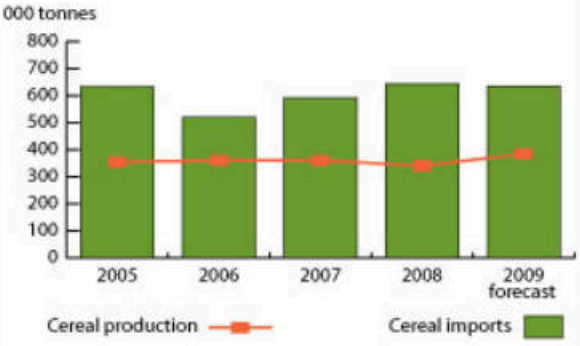
Retail prices of imported rice and maize are constantly declining from the peak registered in mid 2008. In September 2009, depending on markets, imported rice is sold at 44 Gourdes per kg, more than 40 percent below the past peak of 77 Gourdes per kg, but still approximately 12 percent above 2007 prices. At the same time, in the main markets of Port-au-Prince and Cap Haitien, the price of imported maize declined considerably from the record of 58-59 Gourdes per kg registered in August/September 2008.

Crop calendar Haiti



Cereal production and imports Haiti

Cereal production	2004-2008 average	2008	2009 forecast	change 2009/2008
	000 tonnes			percent
Maize	205	200	225	12.5%
Sorghum	88	88	100	13.6%
Rice (milled)	61	53	60	13.2%
Total Cereals	354	341	385	12.9%



Source: FAO/GIEWS Country Cereal Balance Sheets